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MENTEE PLAYBOOK · SOCIAL MEDIA EDITION

# The Client Avatar Guide

Stop marketing to "everybody who files taxes." Build the one person your business is actually built for, then talk directly to them.

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# Why you need an avatar

An avatar is a detailed, semi-fictional portrait of your ideal client. Not a demographic. A person.

**WITHOUT AN AVATAR**

- "I do taxes for everyone!" (and attract nobody)
- Posts that sound like every other preparer
- Price shoppers, last-minute filers, and "can you just do it for free?" texts
- Services built around what you feel like selling

**WITH AN AVATAR**

- Content that makes someone think "she's talking about me"
- Clear offers, clear pricing, clear referrals
- Clients who fit your skills and pay on time
- A year-round business, not a 10-week sprint

**KNOW-IT-ALL TRUTH**

Your target market is a category ("self-employed people"). Your avatar is a human being ("a 34-year-old with a day job and a DoorDash habit who is terrified of the IRS"). Categories don't buy. People do.

## What an avatar does for you

- **Sharpens your message.** You stop writing posts for a crowd and start writing them for one person.
- **Drives your offer.** Their problems decide your services, not the other way around.
- **Cuts your ad and content waste.** You know where they are and what makes them stop scrolling.
- **Makes referrals easy.** People can say "go to her, she works with people like you."

**HEADS UP**

One avatar to start. Mentees who build five avatars on day one end up with five half-baked messages. Nail one, get clients, then add a second.


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# The 7-step build

Do these in order. Use the worksheet on page 6 as you go.

1

### Start with the clients you already love

List your 5 best clients: easy to work with, paid on time, referred others. What do they have in common? Job type, life stage, income pattern, the problem that brought them to you. Your real data beats guessing.

2

### Name them and give them a face

"Side-Hustle Sheila." "Landlord Larry." A name makes the avatar stick in your head and your team's. Add a photo (stock is fine) so you can picture who you're writing to.

3

### Map the basics

Age range, location, family situation, occupation, income pattern (W-2, 1099, business owner, mixed), filing complexity. Keep it to what changes how you serve them. Skip trivia.

4

### Dig into pain, fear, and goals

What keeps them up at night (a balance due, an IRS notice, not knowing their numbers)? What do they want (keep more, stop panicking, get organized, qualify for a loan)? Write it in their words, not tax jargon.

5

### Find their objections

"TurboTax is cheaper." "My cousin does mine for $50." "I don't have anything to deduct." Know every reason they hesitate so you can answer it before they ask.

6

### Locate where they spend their time

Which platforms, groups, podcasts, and people do they trust? Facebook groups, TikTok, Instagram, church, local business networks, their accountant-less friends. Show up where they already are.

7

### Match your services and write the message

Connect each pain to one of your services. Then finish one sentence: "I help [avatar] who [problem] get [result] so they can [bigger life outcome]."


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# Where the answers live

You don't need a focus group. You need to pay attention to what you already have.

### YOUR OWN RECORDS

- Intake forms and organizers: what they ask about most
- Common return types in your best-client list
- Questions that hit your inbox and DMs in February
- Reasons clients left (yes, look at those too)
- Which referrals turned into paying clients

### LISTEN ONLINE

- Comments and questions in tax and small-business Facebook groups
- Reddit threads on side hustles and self-employment
- Replies to your own posts and polls
- Search suggestions: what people type into Google
- Competitors' comment sections (what are people confused about?)

## Ask them directly: 10 questions

1. What made you start looking for help with your taxes or books?
2. What was the most stressful part of last tax season?
3. What did you try before reaching out to a professional?
4. What almost stopped you from hiring someone?
5. How do you feel about your money and records right now?
6. What would "taxes handled" look like for you, in your words?
7. Who do you ask for money advice, and who do you trust?
8. Where do you hang out online and in real life?
9. How did you find me, and what made you pick me?
10. What would you tell a friend in your shoes?

### RULE YOU CANNOT SKIP

Your avatar is a **composite**. Never post or share a real client's name, photo, situation, or return details. Client tax information is protected, and publishing it without the right written consent is a big problem under IRC §7216 and your own professional obligations. Blend traits from several people so nobody can be identified.


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# Example: Side-Hustle Sheila

A sample composite avatar for a virtual tax and bookkeeping practice. Not a real person. Use it as a model, then build your own.

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## Side-Hustle Sheila

Age 28 to 40 · Works a W-2 job and runs a side hustle (delivery, reselling, braiding, content, cleaning) · Rents or owns a starter home · Online most of the day

### PAIN POINTS

- Got hit with an unexpected balance due
- Doesn't know what she can write off
- Mixes personal and business money
- Doesn't know estimated taxes exist

### FEARS

- "Am I doing something illegal?"
- Getting an IRS notice
- Paying a pro and still owing
- Looking clueless in front of a professional

### GOALS

- Keep more of what she earns
- Feel legit and organized
- Qualify for a mortgage or car loan
- Grow the hustle into a real business

### OBJECTIONS

- "TurboTax is $100 cheaper."
- "I barely make anything."
- "I'll get to it in April."
- "A bookkeeper is for big businesses."

### WHERE SHE IS

- TikTok and Instagram Reels
- Facebook hustle and small-business groups
- Group chats with friends and coworkers

### BUYING TRIGGERS

- A payment-app or 1099 form shows up
- Tax season panic
- Needs proof of income for a loan
- Friend gets a bigger refund

### HER WORDS

*"I just need someone to tell me what I'm supposed to be doing so I don't mess it up."*

### SERVICES THAT FIT

Self-employed tax prep · Monthly bookkeeping · Quarterly estimate planning · Business setup and entity guidance · Tax-ready organizer

### MESSAGE STATEMENT

**"I help side-hustlers who are scared of tax season get organized and stop overpaying, so they can grow their hustle into a real business."**


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# Build your avatar

**AVATAR NAME**
Alliterative names stick

**AGE · LOCATION · HOUSEHOLD**

**OCCUPATION AND INCOME TYPE**
W-2, 1099, owner, mixed

**FILING COMPLEXITY**
Schedule C, rentals, crypto, multi-state...

**TOP 3 PAIN POINTS**

**TOP 3 FEARS**

**GOALS AND DREAMS**
Tax and life

**OBJECTIONS**
Why they say "not yet"

**WHERE THEY SPEND TIME**
Platforms, groups, people

**BUYING TRIGGERS**
What makes them act now

**THEIR EXACT WORDS**
Phrases you've heard from real people

**SERVICES THAT SOLVE THEIR PROBLEMS**

**MY MESSAGE STATEMENT**
"I help [avatar] who [problem] get [result] so they can [bigger outcome]."


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# Turn your avatar into content

An avatar you never use is a hobby. Here is how to put it to work this week.

## 6 hook formulas

1. **Call them out:** "If you drive for DoorDash and file your own taxes, read this."
2. **Name the fear:** "Scared of an IRS letter? Here's what the first one usually means."
3. **Bust the myth:** "'I don't make enough to file.' Let's talk."
4. **Answer the objection:** "Why the cheapest preparer can cost you more."
5. **Use their words:** Turn a real client question (anonymized) into a post.
6. **Show the shift:** "Before I got organized / after" stories as composites.

## A simple weekly rhythm

**MON TO WED**

- 1 educational post or Reel
- 1 myth-buster
- Reply to every comment

**THU TO SUN**

- 1 story or behind-the-scenes
- 1 clear call to action (book, DM, join list)
- 1 engagement question

**MENTOR NOTE: STAY COMPLIANT**

- No guarantees of refund size, audit outcomes, or "maximum refund." You don't control those.
- Describe your credential accurately. If you are an Annual Filing Season Program participant, say exactly that. Do not say "certified," "licensed," or imply you are an EA, CPA, or attorney.
- Educational content is general information, not individual tax advice. Add a short disclaimer to long-form posts.
- Follow IRS Circular 230 rules on advertising and fees if they apply to you, and your state's preparer rules.


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# Your avatar checklist

- [ ] Listed my 5 best clients and their common traits
- [ ] Named my avatar and picked a face
- [ ] Wrote their pain, fear, goal, and objection list in their own words
- [ ] Found the 2 to 3 places they spend time
- [ ] Matched my services to their problems
- [ ] Finished my message statement
- [ ] Scheduled this week's posts
- [ ] Confirmed my avatar is a composite and my posts are compliant

Review your avatar every tax season. People change, platforms change, and your best clients will tell you what you missed.

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